Moritz Hörl

PhD Candidate · Vienna University of Economics and Business (WU)

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EDUCATION

PhD in Economics and Social Sciences 2024–present
WU Vienna
Dissertation: *Essays on Social Mobility and Equality of Opportunity*
Supervisors: Astrid Pennerstorfer (WU), Mark Fabian (Warwick), Jan Stuhler (UC3M)
Research visit: London School of Economics (LSE), October–December 2026

Research Master in Philosophy and Economics 2021–2023
Erasmus University Rotterdam
Additional coursework at Utrecht University (Mathematics, Econometrics, Microeconomics)

BSc in Economics and Social Sciences (Major: Economics) 2017–2021
WU Vienna

BA in Philosophy 2017–2021
University of Vienna

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Social Mobility · Labour Economics · Statistical Learning · Philosophy of Science

PUBLICATIONS

- **Stylized Facts about Attitudes toward Inequality: A Contrast between Income and Wealth.** (with Nhat An Trinh, Federico Scalese, and Mihaela Pop)
  Historical Social Research, Special Issue on Perceptions of Wealth Inequality, forthcoming 2026.

WORKING PAPERS

- **Thick Concept, Thin Consensus: Normative Judgments in Estimating Inequality of Opportunity.** Revise & Resubmit, *Economics & Philosophy*.
- **What Do People Mean by Social Mobility? Dimensions, Indicators, and the Great Gatsby Curve.** (with Michael Keinprecht)
- **Beyond Average Social Mobility: The Distribution of Economic Opportunity.**
- **The Intergenerational Mobility Paradox in a Dual Education System.** (with Wolfgang Frimmel, Martin Halla, et al.)

WORK IN PROGRESS

- **Who Holds the Key? School Gatekeeping, Parental Discretion and the Effects of Deviating from School-Entry Rules.** (with Anna Schwarz)
- **Within-Family Inequality.** (with Samuel Bowles, Wendy Carlin, et al.)

FELLOWSHIPS, GRANTS & AWARDS

DOC Fellowship, Austrian Academy of Sciences (ÖAW) (€104,280) 2027–2029 (awarded 2026)
Competitive doctoral fellowship awarded to outstanding PhD students across all disciplines.

LSE III Visiting PhD Grant (£3,500) 2026
Opportunity and Mobility Research Programme, International Inequalities Institute, LSE.

Research Grant, WU Vienna (€7,000) 2025
Principal Investigator (with Michael Keinprecht): *What Is Social Mobility? Democratizing the Measurement of Opportunity*.

INEM Young Scholar Award ($750) 2025
Best Paper Award, International Network for Economic Method.

Performance Scholarships, WU Vienna and University of Vienna (€850 p.a. each) 2018–2021

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

- **What Do People Mean by Social Mobility?**
  Atkinson Conference on Social and Economic Inequality, Nuffield College, Oxford (2026); Inequalities and Opportunities Conference, Bari (2026)
- **Thick Concept, Thin Consensus**
  PPE Society, King's College London (2025); INEM, Bayreuth (2025); WU Vienna (2024)
- **Beyond Average Social Mobility**
  Economics Research Seminar, WU Vienna (2026); Winter School on Inequality and Social Welfare Theory, Canazei (2026); EIPE, Erasmus University Rotterdam (2025)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant 2023–2024
Institute for Advanced Studies (IHS), Vienna
Developed nowcasting models using machine learning in R.

Research Intern 2023
Central Bank of Austria (OeNB), Vienna
Processed microdata and applied econometric models for firm-level policy analysis.

Student Research Assistant 2020–2021
Institute of Social Policy, WU Vienna
Data collection and literature research.

TEACHING

Introduction to Empirical Inequality Research 2026–present
Undergraduate, WU Vienna

Economics of Distribution 2025–present
Undergraduate, WU Vienna

Supervision of Bachelor Theses (3)
WU Vienna

Teaching Assistant, Empirical Research Methods 2022–2023
Erasmus University Rotterdam
Led tutorials and graded assignments.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Referee for *European Sociological Review*.

PUBLIC WRITING

„Was ist gerecht? Chancengerechtigkeit messen heißt auch Werte diskutieren." *Die Presse*, 25 August 2025.
(What is fair? Measuring equality of opportunity also means discussing values.)

REFERENCES

Available upon request.